2.2. Simple expressions

An expression is something that can be *evaluated*. An expression has a value. Almost everything in CoffeeScript is an expression. CoffeeScript even goes to some effort to make some things expressions that aren't expressions in the underlying JavaScript. This emphasis on expressions means that they're a good place to start exploring the syntax of CoffeeScript —starting with small expressions and moving on to larger ones.

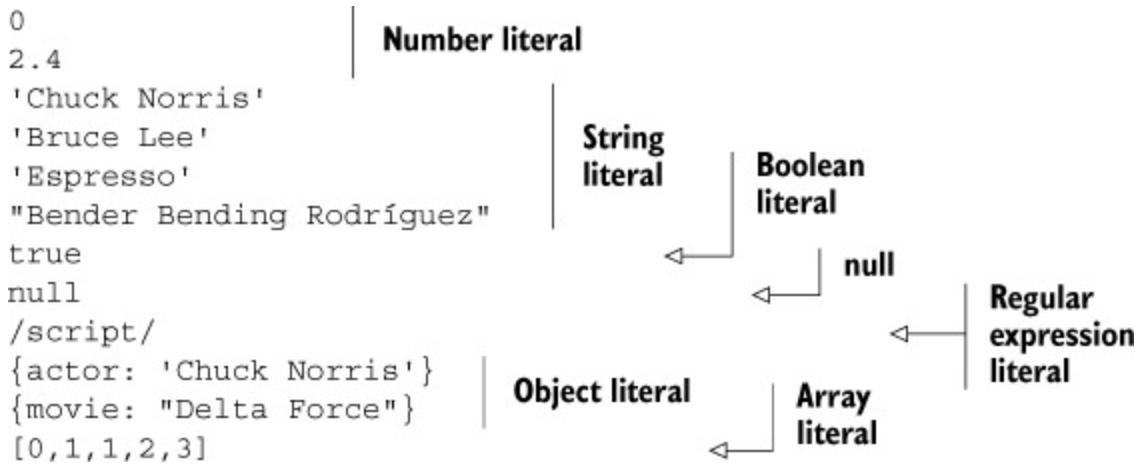
All of the examples in this section can be run on the CoffeeScript Read-Eval-Print Loop (REPL). Start your REPL:

```
> coffee
coffee>
```

Ready?

2.2.1. Literal values

The smallest expressions in CoffeeScript are ones that evaluate to themselves. When you type them into the REPL and press Enter, you see the same thing shown on the next line. These expressions are called *literal values*, and the notation used to write them is called *literal notation*:



The CoffeeScript literal values shown here are exactly the same in JavaScript. Not all literal values are the same though, so everybody (even